Siphiwo Sizonqoba Manana

UX/UI & PRODUCT DESIGN | ENTERPRISE WORKFLOWS, CRO & ANALYTICS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

UX/UI and product design consultant with digital design experience since 2019, spanning client websites, e-commerce and social-media advertising, followed by financial services, fintech, B2B and SaaS work. Designed two shipped HubSpot UI extensions and an internal CPQ platform replacing spreadsheet-led scoping. Combines complex workflow design, behavioural research and engineering collaboration with CRO instrumentation and experimentation. Led engagements up to $52,000 and presented evidence-led recommendations to CEOs and marketing leaders.

Also builds self-initiated software and validation tools, including a deployed private beta, combining hands-on product ownership with AI-assisted development, testing and user-feedback iteration.

CORE SKILLS

Product and platform design: Enterprise UX, B2B workflows, internal tools, HubSpot CRM and UI extensions, CPQ, interaction design, design for React implementation and annotated developer handoff

Research and UX: Behavioural segmentation around existing personas, usability research and testing, synthesis, information architecture, user flows, wireframes and interactive prototypes

Figma and visual design: Confident daily Auto Layout, components, variants, design systems and libraries, responsive high-fidelity UI, FigJam, Adobe XD, Sketch and Adobe Creative Suite

Conversion optimisation: CRO strategy, heuristic audits and scoring, prioritised hypotheses, A/B testing in VWO, Convert, GA4 experiments and HubSpot, funnel analysis and baseline validation

Analytics and instrumentation: GA4, GTM custom JavaScript variables, dataLayer, events and parameters, trigger audits, Clarity heatmaps, recordings, funnels and segments, Looker Studio and HubSpot reporting

Accessibility and QA: WCAG 2.1 AA, design-stage contrast checks, alt-text and asset-naming standards, post-deployment checks and design-to-development regression review

Front-end and CMS: HTML, CSS, WordPress, Elementor, UTM tracking, form and API integration, site performance, plugin updates, backups and technical maintenance

Delivery and collaboration: Client workshops and presentations, scope and roadmaps, ClickUp process design and sprint coordination, AI-assisted templates and estimation. Remote collaboration: Google Workspace, Slack, Zoom and Microsoft Teams.

AI-assisted software and validation: Codex-supported delivery; Next.js, React, TypeScript and Supabase within a deployed private beta; REST APIs, regression checks, structured data capture and semi-automated spreadsheets.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX/UI Consultant | Evara, formerly Inbound FinTech | London, UK
June 2025 - September 2026 | Remote from South Africa via Remote.com

UK-based Elite HubSpot Solutions Partner serving financial services, fintech and B2B clients. Owned UX/UI, CRO and measurement across multiple engagements, collaborating with project managers and developers. Named Best Agency of the Year at the 2025 FinTech Marketing Global Awards.

Enterprise product and platform design

- Designed the UI/UX of Evara's internal Configure, Price, Quote (CPQ) platform in Figma, replacing spreadsheet-based service scoping with a structured HubSpot-connected workflow. Organised a six-pillar service catalogue and designed service selection, parameter configuration, dynamic and module-level pricing, line-item generation, discounts, delivery timelines, payment terms and final review. Delivered the design in two days alongside client projects. Developers owned the integration, backend automation and pricing engine.

- Design lead on a shipped CPQ quote cockpit for Cambridge Commodities, a commodities business. Designed a HubSpot UI extension embedded in a CRM record, surfacing live cost and stock data from Ross ERP and historical pricing from Snowflake. Worked with a project manager and developer; owned the interface, not the integrations.
- Resolved HubSpot UI-extension constraints using the platform's real components rather than custom CSS. Derived a click-to-edit pattern from 240px minimum input widths within 774px of available space, and checked table-overflow behaviour against platform documentation.
- Produced 43 frames covering the full quote lifecycle with failure states designed as first-class flows: partial ERP failure, order rejection, unreachable data warehouse, and a mandatory re-simulation gate catching stock shortages before any write. Surfaced three unresolved architectural questions as annotations for the developer rather than deciding them silently.
- Delivered a click-through prototype with six named walkthroughs and plain-language handover, enabling the project manager and developer to run client sessions independently. Maintained fidelity across 3,000+ HubSpot component instances and two local copies, annotating every deviation and its rationale.
- Designed a separate shipped CPQ for B2B data-management client Redslim, improving quoting speed and accuracy. Mapped 50 pricing rules into a three-step configuration flow with visible overrides and searchable pricing guidance. Owned interface and flow design, not the pricing engine, backend automation or integration.

Behavioural research and segmentation

- Delivered behavioural research, a CRO implementation and segmentation strategy, and a post-launch monitoring framework that informed B2B data-management client Redslim's website redesign and rebrand.
- Built on existing marketing personas to develop five behavioural segments: research-oriented visitors, solution seekers, enterprise buyers, returning visitors, and referral or partner visitors. Connected their needs to journey and content recommendations.
- Reviewed 54 Microsoft Clarity session recordings, comprising 30 returning-user and 24 new-user sessions, alongside five GA4 path explorations and two macro funnels. Synthesised observed friction and journey patterns into actionable design recommendations.
- Developed 23 prioritised CRO hypotheses and a three-stage implementation and segmentation plan covering 20 workstreams. Recommendations addressed CTA visibility, trust, form interactions, solution and case-study templates, mobile journeys and navigation.
- Connected proposed changes to measurement requirements and a post-launch monitoring framework, giving the redesign team a structured basis for prioritisation and future validation.
- Owned the behavioural research, segmentation, synthesis, hypotheses and roadmap. The marketing personas already existed; another agency executed the website redesign. This was a separate engagement from the shipped Redslim CPQ product. The hypotheses were a proposed testing backlog, not completed experiments or a measured conversion uplift.

Conversion optimisation and measurement

- Owned the full CRO measurement loop across client accounts: heuristic audits and scoring, baseline capture, hypotheses, approved design changes, GTM re-instrumentation and testing, then 60-90 days of data collection and validation against the baseline and agreed success metrics. Reported findings through Looker Studio and client presentations.
- Designed and ran VWO and Convert A/B tests on the homepage of network and cloud-services client BSO. Tested dual CTA placement at observed hesitation and scroll-depth points against CTA weight, emphasis and copy variations, measuring bounce rate, page engagement and engagement time.
- A client demo funnel moved from roughly 33% to 75% completion after form restructuring and re-instrumentation: approximately 100 submissions from 300 starts, then 300 from 400. This was a directional programme result from combined design and tracking changes, not an isolated A/B-test lift.
- Diagnosed a compound tracking and media failure corrupting a client funnel: form-start events were firing on page view rather than user interaction, inflating starts. Traced the anomaly through GA4 into the client paid media platform, where geo-targeting had drifted outside their ICP as the system optimised for cheaper clicks, inflating traffic and recorded conversions alike.

- Built a custom Google Tag Manager JavaScript variable reading the data-step attribute on a multi-step demo form at the moment of click, distinguishing step-one from step-two continue events and enabling step-by-step funnel measurement where none previously existed.
- Developed a semi-automated behavioural metric framework scoring user behaviour on quantified signals including rage clicks, scroll depth and dead zones, reported to clients through Looker Studio.
- Built two internal tools now used by the delivery team: an audit scorer covering front-end and back-end conversion factors, and an unmoderated usability testing tool.
- Ran GTM audits on inherited accounts where triggers were missing or incorrectly implemented, rebuilt the tracking, then collected sixty to ninety days of clean data before writing any hypothesis, so recommendations rested on measurement rather than assumption.
- Achieved roughly 70 to 80% implementation of recommendations by pairing each to the client's own data and to the behavioural mechanism behind it.

Client delivery and design operations

- Delivery lead on a $52,000 UX and CRO rebuild for Apella Wealth, a US financial-planning firm. Led discovery, site architecture, homepage wireframes, trust-signal placement and above-the-fold hierarchy with a project manager.
- Built a twelve-month CRO roadmap for Dayshape, an AI-powered resource management platform used by professional services firms across 55 countries, covering full CRO audit, hypothesis design and phased implementation, presented directly to the client marketing lead. Contributed to the WordPress to HubSpot site rebuild, navigation and mega menu structure, demo request page optimisation and resources page UX.
- Led homepage, navigation-header and FAQ CRO analysis for Ruleguard, a UK regulatory-technology platform, and specified a sitewide GTM event-tracking schema.
- Contributed to the Employmate CRO programme, including a persona switch giving employers and job seekers separate content paths through a single site, journey friction removal, and rebuilt landing pages, CTAs and forms. Published as a case study by Evara, which credits me by name.
- Presented audits, hypothesis documents and multi-month roadmaps directly to CEOs and Heads of Marketing. That work converted into expanded retainers and increased scope on multiple accounts, including Dayshape moving to a larger package for faster delivery.
- Authored WCAG 2.1 AA contrast and alt-text standards applied in Figma at design stage and re-verified during post-deployment QA, catching accessibility regressions in design-to-development translation.
- Built and documented delivery processes, guidelines and AI-assisted ClickUp templates that standardised task setup and estimation and cut project set-up time. Adopted by squads beyond my own function.
- Ran monthly internal knowledge shares and presented at company conferences on CRO method, tooling and measurement.
- Reviewed developer builds and guided implementation decisions, resolving visual and behavioural drift through documented feedback and clarifications. Managed client communication through founder and senior-leadership level and helped set up assessment tasks for prospective employees.
- Facilitated design working sessions with project managers, client stakeholders, developers and occasionally SEO, guiding option comparisons and priorities using research, design principles and expected outcomes.
- Collaborated remotely using Slack for internal communication across departments, colleagues and contractors; used Google Workspace, Zoom and Microsoft Teams for client collaboration according to each client's platform.
- Conducted task-based prototype and interaction reviews with colleagues and senior stakeholders, most recently on Apella Wealth. Used feedback to improve journey clarity and resolve unclear or faulty interactions before developer handoff; continuing project support after formal employment ended.

UI/UX Designer and Front-End Developer | SearchKings Africa | Johannesburg, South Africa
September 2022 - June 2025 | Hybrid
Google Ads and lead-generation agency serving clients across multiple industries. Designed and built the websites, landing pages and lead-capture journeys used by paid campaigns, combining UX work with hands-on front-end delivery.

- Designed and built responsive landing pages, sales pages and lead capture forms in WordPress and Elementor using HTML and CSS, implementing UTM tracking so campaign performance could be attributed rather than estimated.

- Led website and interface redesigns across client accounts, introducing user flows and information architecture into a team process that had previously worked straight from visual comps.
- Developed and scaled design systems and modular UI component libraries, improving visual consistency and cutting design turnaround across repeat client work.
- Produced performance creative at volume alongside interface work: static and animated banner sets, newsletters, campaign assets and login interfaces, all built to a conversion brief rather than a brand one.
- Integrated and tested API solutions for e-commerce and lead-generation forms, improving conversion paths.
- Ran usability research and A/B testing, using analytics insight to refine interfaces.
- Managed site performance and security across client sites, including plugin updates, backups and technical enhancements.

Co-Founder, Design and Marketing Lead | Apollo V Academy | Johannesburg, South Africa
2019 - September 2022 | Self-employed; initially alongside full-time employment

Co-founded a two-partner apparel, vinyl, e-commerce, design-services and academy venture. Work began in 2019; registered in 2020. Served external businesses and our own website, employing an administrator and engaging a contractor. The registered business traded for 25 months until 2022.

- Built and ran the venture's e-commerce website and lead capture, owning the acquisition and conversion journey with personal capital at risk and connecting design decisions to purchasing behaviour.
- Designed and delivered websites, branding and digital assets for external businesses, taking briefs from specification to finished work. Connected business needs to customer journeys and visual communication, building the client-facing website experience later applied at SearchKings.
- Handled social-media advertising, not Google Ads, alongside digital, social and print campaigns. Created web, email, newsletter and video assets for acquisition and offer communication, plus apparel, vinyl and signage. This experience led to the SearchKings opportunity.
- Built brand guidelines and reusable design templates, improving consistency and production speed across client work. Balanced creative delivery with the commercial responsibilities of operating the business.

Graphic and Clothing Designer | Anatomic Sportswear | South Africa
June 2022 - September 2022

- Designed custom and branded cycling apparel using CorelDRAW and Adobe Illustrator, developing initial concepts into production-ready artwork.
- Prepared garment layouts, colour-ways, branding placements and vector graphics for production.
- Refined artwork against garment templates and specifications to maintain accurate scale, proportion and visual consistency.

INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS & PRACTICAL AUTOMATION

Current self-initiated work combining product ownership, AI-assisted development, validation and iteration. These projects are separate from employed client engagements.

- Worth Applying, deployed private beta: Built a job-sourcing and application-support tool now tested by close friends and family. Own requirements, user journeys, priorities, tester feedback and release decisions; investigate failures, make updates and continue monitoring behaviour.
- Developed the beta through AI-assisted implementation with Codex using Next.js, React, TypeScript and Supabase/PostgreSQL. Connected public job-source APIs, email-code authentication, account-specific storage and document extraction. Added vacancy deduplication, source filtering and revision-conflict handling. The current runtime uses deterministic logic, not a live LLM.
- Project records document 188 passing automated tests, TypeScript and build checks in the latest reviewed verification, plus live database ownership checks. Addressed PDF-import compatibility and unsuitable application routes. Use automated results alongside manual review, live-service checks and tester reports to guide fixes.
- PINE: Built and personally use a self-initiated audit tool with human verification of outputs. Not publicly released. Also developed data-validation and semi-automated spreadsheets to support accurate client data capture and review.

- Created departmental assistant skills supporting client website design and development. Further workflow automation and a Notion-backed knowledge and coordination layer are planned, not yet deployed orchestration.
- Developing an investment/trading education and assistance tool. The in-development project focuses on learning, research-backed hypotheses and simulated evaluation.

EARLIER COMMERCIAL EXPERIENCE

Finance Administrator | Arcfyre International

April 2018 - July 2020

Training Administrator | Altor International

July 2020 - March 2021 | Overlapped with the launch of Apollo V

Accounting and financial administration, followed by administration for a private-security training academy. This experience provides commercial and numerical grounding for evaluating business processes and conversion outcomes.

SELECTED PORTFOLIO EVIDENCE

- Redslim (B2B data management): behavioural research and website CRO roadmap. View case study
- Dayshape (resource-management SaaS): navigation, demo and resource UX. Employer-published case study
- Employmate (recruitment): audience journeys, landing pages and forms. Employer-published case study
- BSO (network/cloud services): CTA experiments and measurement caveats. View case study
- Evara CPQ (internal platform): a quoting flow replacing spreadsheet-led scoping. View case study
- Evara CPQ (internal platform): employer-published article and a video of me presenting the platform. View article and walkthrough

EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

BCom International Business: MANCOSA (Management College of South Africa), completed 2023

Project Management Programme: PM.Ideas, completed 2024; CAPM certification exam pending

Selected training: Google Tag Manager Fundamentals (Analytics Mania, 2025); Google Analytics (Google Skillshop); HubSpot Reporting and Inbound Marketing Optimization (HubSpot Academy); Master Figma: Web and Mobile App Design (Udemy)